10.1 Unit description

Introduction

Students are expected to develop wide knowledge and understanding of experimental procedures and techniques throughout the whole of their International Advanced Level course. They are expected to become aware of how these techniques might be used to investigate interesting biological questions.

This unit will assess students' knowledge and understanding of experimental procedures and techniques and their ability to plan whole investigations, analyse data and to evaluate their results and experimental methodology.

Development of practical skills, knowledge and understanding

Students should undertake a variety of practical work and investigations during the IAS and IA2 course to develop their practical skills and extend their knowledge of useful procedures and techniques.

To prepare students effectively for this paper it is essential that centres provide opportunities for students to plan investigations, implement their plans, collect data, analyse their data, draw conclusions and evaluate their findings. It will be helpful to students for centres to approach the practical procedures and techniques named in the specification in the context of simple investigations rather than as isolated skills.

How Science Works

How Science Works is a major underlying theme for the whole International Advanced Level examination. This assessment is designed to test statements 2–6 of this theme. Full details are given on page 12 of the specification.